

8-Bit Theater District: Post-Production Pipeline Evolution V1-V11

Brand Identity: No Code. No Pulp. All Pixels. Zero B.S.

This document serves as the clinical breakdown of the evolution of our proprietary post-production pipeline, strictly adhering to the [Workspace Environment Rules](#).

LOG ENTRY: 06.22.2026 — WORKSPACE INITIALIZATION & COLD CONNECTION

Initialization phase. The objective was the establishment of the Full Machine directory access and the implementation of initial directory scaffolding. All necessary skills were configured to ensure the environment met the baseline requirements for the V1 pipeline.

- Objective: Directory scaffolding and environment readiness.
- Status: Connection established.

LOG ENTRY: 06.23.2026 — THE PREMIERE LOCKOUT & MCP PIPELINE BREAKDOWN

The pipeline encountered a critical failure within Premiere Pro. Local Windows Named Pipe datacloud socket connection timeouts were identified, exacerbated by WS2/virtualization port intercepts. Premiere Pro's inherent lack of native .jsx run menus necessitated an immediate architectural shift.

- **Correction:** Manual cleaning of `mcp_config.json` was required to sever the IDE extension loop.
- **Discovery:** Premiere Pro remains unsuitable for direct script execution in the current workflow.

LOG ENTRY: 06.24.2026 — COMPOSITION ACQUISITION & THE V1 DUOTONE CRASH

Pivot to After Effects. The transition was initially stalled by silent execution failures caused by target mismatching. The V1 color math utilized a brute-force 100% duotone mapping strategy.

- **Technical Result:** The output was visually unacceptable, presenting as a bleached-out negative.
- **Roadblock:** ExtendScript match name property failures, specifically involving 'ADBE Glow2', prevented automated effect application.

LOG ENTRY: 06.25.2026 — LAYER STACKING & THE GHOST COMPOSITION GRIDLOCK

A major sequence layering failure was detected. Assets were stacking at 0:00:00:00 or disappearing entirely beyond the composition time boundaries. This was traced back to duration metadata failures in the ingest script.

- **Solution:** Implemented a diagonal cascade automation by resolving duration metadata.
- **Strategy:** Shifted toward using property indexes instead of localized names to bypass regional string errors in ExtendScript.

LOG ENTRY: 06.26.2026 — THE REFINEMENT LOOP & CRUSHING BLACKS (V2-V8)

V2 through V8 focused on creative math correction. The 100% duotone tint/posterization model was scrapped in favor of a Tritone process.

- **Black Crush Layer Injection:** A Levels effect was injected prior to grading to clip bottom luma levels by 12%. This successfully stripped the gray haze from the raw pixel data.
- **Glow Constraint:** Clamped the glow radius to 10px to minimize unwanted light pollution across the frame.

LOG ENTRY: 06.27.2026 — ANAMORPHIC HALATION & PIPELINE FREEZE (V9-V11)

Finalization of the V11 pipeline. The Tritone wash has been dialed back to a 10% accent to preserve realistic skin tones while maintaining environment light isolation.

- **Anamorphic Halation:** Glow Threshold set to 75% with a 28px radius and 0.18 intensity. This math ensures light halos are strictly clamped to emission sources and ignore shadows entirely.
- **Optimization:** Render times have been localized to hardware capabilities, concluding the pipeline freeze for the current cycle.

TECHNICAL SUMMARY & ERROR MANAGEMENT

Component	Parameter	Strategy
Color Math	Tritone	Dialed 40% down to 10% opacity
Luma Control	Levels	12% bottom luma clip
Glow Threshold	75%	28px radius / 0.18 intensity
Script Logic	Try/Catch	Use property indexes over Match Names

Zero B.S. Protocol: All future iterations must maintain the 75% threshold to prevent highlight bleed into non-emissive textures. Pipeline V11 is now the operational standard.